Improving the quality of tourist services

Daniela Šálková[1], *Sergey* Yekimov[1,*], *Renáta* Křečková[1], *Olena* Yarmoliuk [2], *Bobur* Sobirov[3], *Roman* Oleksenko[4], and *Vitalii* Ihnatiev[5]

[1]Czech University of Life Sciences Prague, Kamycka 129, 16500, Praha - Suchdol, Czech Republic
[2]Polissia National University,Zhytomyr , 10008 Ukraine
[3]Tashkent State University of Economics Samarkand branch, Samarkand, Uzbekistan
[4]Volodymyr Vynnychenko Central Ukrainian State University, Kropyvnytskyi, Ukraine
[5]Rivne State Humanities University, Kropyvnytskyi, Ukraine

Abstract. For the tourism industry, the quality of tourist services is important. Hotels, motels, tour bureaus, travel agencies may have approximately the same material base, but the greatest success is achieved by those who provide better services in accordance with customer requests. The level of quality of tourist services is correlated with a variety of objective and subjective factors . A travel company must have its own quality standards for the provision of travel services that would meet the requirements of potential consumers and industry standards. The consistently high quality of tourist services makes it possible for the tourist company to occupy its niche in the market of tourist services. Improving the competence and professional training of the staff of the tourism company, quality management of the provision of tourist services the use of modern information technologies of interaction with customers contributes to improving the quality of tourist services. The process of managing the quality of tourist services should be contained in the long-term development strategy of the enterprise. The quality of tourist services depends on a large number of different psychological , technical , economic and social factors . Travel companies should implement a targeted policy of improving the quality of services provided using a variety of tools to achieve this goal . Among these tools , the most important role is played by the professional development of the staff of travel companies .

1 Introduction

According to [1], quality is a set of characteristics and features of a service or product that is designed to satisfy some human needs.

According to [2], quality is closely correlated with such categories as the basis of social and economic life

The quality of the product depends on the specific parameters of this product , which can be measured during its production . At the same time, the quality of a service can be determined only during its consumption, since the production process and the consumption process coincide in time.

* Corresponding author: rusnauka@email.cz

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That is , quality can be interpreted as a consumer property of a product , or a useful property of a service for its consumer . The quality of the product is proportional to the degree of satisfaction from the use of the product or the consumption of the service.

In travel companies, in order to provide competitive services, they must not only guarantee their quality, but also continuously carry out the process of maintaining the quality management system at the proper level, the most important attribute in the fight for potential consumers.

According to [3], the value and quality of the consumed service for the consumer are inseparable parameters. At the same time, for different consumers, the concept of service quality may differ to a certain extent, depending on its price and the degree of usefulness for each consumer.

Since the quality is influenced by a huge number of diverse, including random factors, travel companies must constantly maintain the quality of tourist services at the proper level.

According to [4], a competitive tourist service should provide maximum comfort for consumers, have a high level of attractiveness, and its consumption should be prestigious.

According to [5], a competitive tourist service should have the following properties (Fig.1).

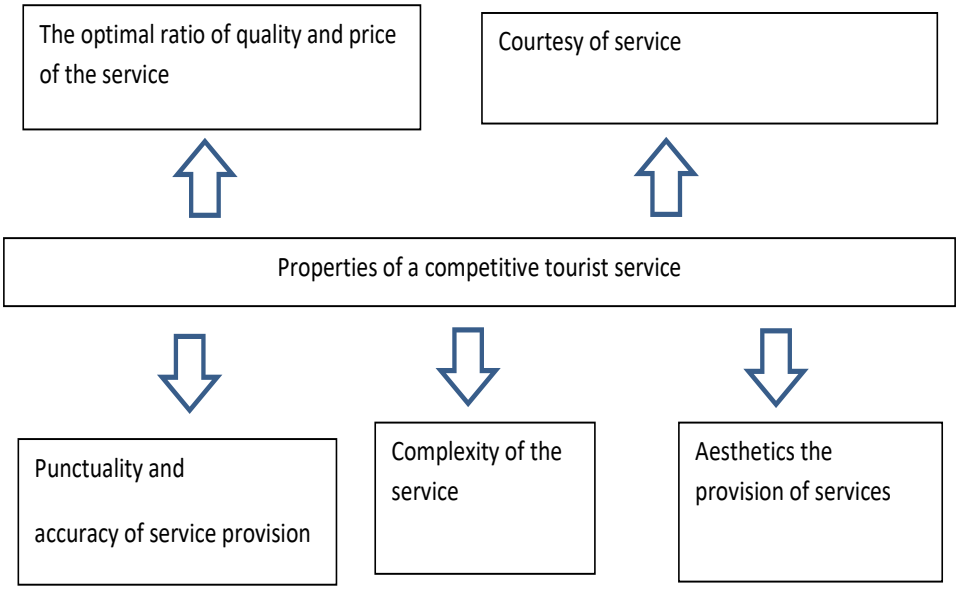

Fig.1. Properties of a competitive tourist service

In accordance with the international standard ISO 8420 quality is the ability of an object to meet certain needs.

According to [6], quality is the most important tool of non-price competition. The good quality of the purchased goods or services can increase customer loyalty, and therefore it can become a prerequisite for further sales of products.

According to [7], the manufactured high-quality products have a beneficial effect on the labor collective of the enterprise, serves as an additional motivating factor for productive labor activity.

In accordance with the concept of TQM (Total quality management), the quality management model at the enterprise should be based on the following principles [8] (Fig. 2)

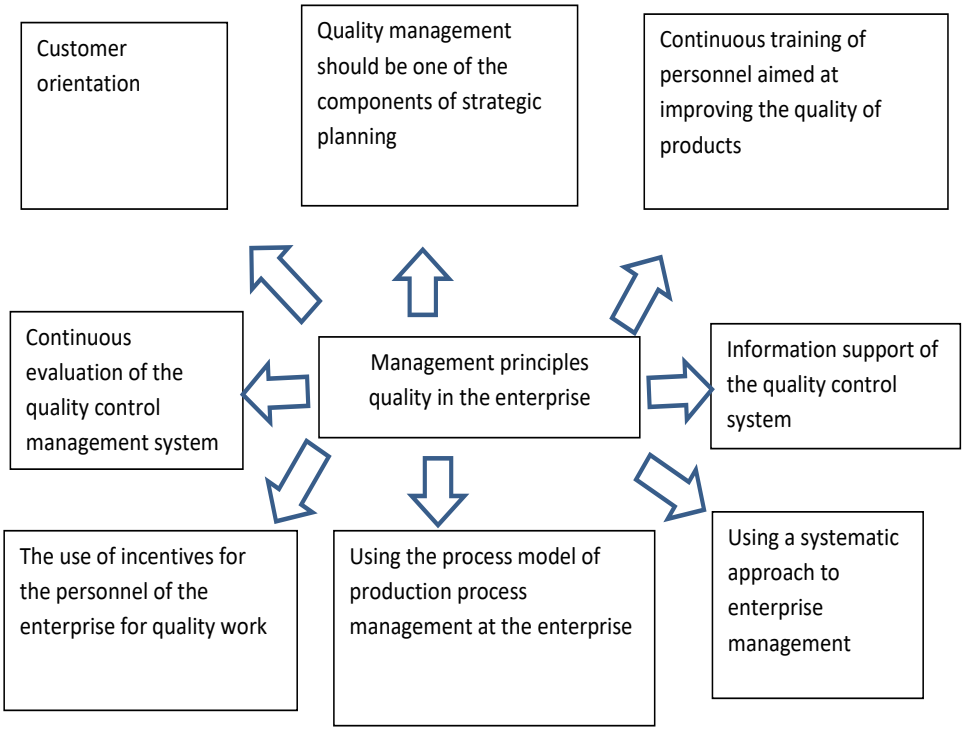

Fig. 2. Management principles quality in the enterprise

According to [9], the main problems related to the quality of tourist services are related to the fact that:

1) There is a misunderstanding of customer expectations and needs.
2) The company uses erroneous standards for the provision of tourist services
3) The staff of travel companies does not have a sufficient level of qualification
4) The problem of insurance of persons using tourist services is poorly solved.

2 Methods

In this study, an analytical method was used, with the help of which the studied problems were studied in their unity and development. Taking into account the goals and objectives of the conducted research, a functional-structural method of scientific research was used. This allowed us to study some problems of improving the quality of services provided by travel companies

3 Results

Among the main reasons affecting the quality of tourist services provided are:

1) insufficient development of transport infrastructure facilities (roads, hotels, motels, airports, train stations, etc.),
2) Insufficient use of effective information technologies.

3) Poor quality customer service.

To solve these problems, it is proposed :

1. To recruit the staff of travel companies primarily of their specialists with specialized education in the field of tourism.
2. The management of travel companies should regularly conduct seminars, trainings, webinars dedicated to improving the quality of customer service.
3. Tourism employees should be trained in teamwork skills.
4. Regularly analyze personal and group relationships within the labor collective, in order to quickly respond to customer requests.

To improve the quality of tourist services, you should:

1. Systematically analyze customers' consumer preferences.
2. To achieve a flexible approach in the provision of tourist services, taking into account the wishes of specific customers.
3. Provide the staff of travel companies with comfortable and ergonomic workplaces.
4. Clearly formulate the responsibilities of each employee and the scheme of their interaction in solving certain production problems.
5. Clearly formulate a system of material and moral incentives for the effective work of employees.
6. Optimize information flows at the enterprise, adapt them to the remote work of the staff of the travel company.

In order to carry out comprehensive control over the quality of tourist services provided, it is recommended :

1. Development and implementation of objective criteria for assessing the quality of the staff of a travel company.
2. Creation of a quality service within the framework of a travel company and work with customer complaints.
3. To attract clients of travel companies to evaluate the quality of travel services
4. Formation of a technological process that provides high-quality service to each client.
5. Providing information comfort about customer service

The management of a travel company must correctly assess the objective processes affecting the quality of tourist services (weather disasters, political processes, price fluctuations).

4 Discussion

In the tourism industry, the quality of tourist services is of key importance. Tour bureaus, hotels, travel agencies may have approximately the same material base, but the greatest success is achieved by those who can provide better services in accordance with customer requests.

The quality of tourist services depends on many objective and subjective factors . A travel company must have its own quality standards for the provision of travel services that would meet industry standards and the requirements of potential consumers.

Consistently high quality of tourist services will allow the tourist company to occupy its niche in the market of tourist services

Improving the competence and professional training of the staff of the tourism company, quality management of the provision of tourist services the use of modern information technologies of interaction with customers contributes to improving the quality of tourist services.

5 Conclusions

The process of managing the quality of tourist services should be contained in the long-term development strategy of the enterprise.

The quality of tourist services depends on a large number of different psychological , technical , economic and social factors . Travel companies should implement a targeted policy of improving the quality of services provided using a variety of tools to achieve this goal . Among these tools , the most important role is played by the professional development of the staff of travel companies .

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